

FAKE DRAIN

Another beauty from WalletPop.com, this one involves a little more handiwork. By constructing a false drain in the floor of your garage or basement, you can place a pipe full of money where no one can see. (Just make sure your cash is stored in a watertight container or baggie, in case an unknowing person tries to use the drain!)

THE YARD

Digging holes and hiding money is an age-old practice. The key is to remember where you put the cash and keeping it safe from the elements. Most experts recommend using some kind of PVC piping to keep dirt away from the stash, and to discourage the ground from caving in. This will also prevent a pesky underground burrowing creature from discovering your secret. (Be sure to bury deep, and don't forget where you hid it!)

RETURN-AIR VENT

To see this one in detail, you'd have to snag an old issue of *The Family Handyman* magazine (November 2008). It offers step-by-step directions for using the faceplate of an air vent to conceal a cubby you can stash

valuables in. The best part is that it is held in place by magnets (to give you fast access to your own cash), and the sawed-off screw heads give the whole thing a look of really being secured to your wall. If you use your imagination, you could probably rig one up without the directions.

FROZEN FOOD

I wouldn't put your bling in a box of Pizza Rolls, but if you have some aging frozen haggis or a box of hominy you're not overly attached to, you can use it as a covert hiding place for a wad of twenties.

TENNIS BALL

I like this idea of cutting open a tennis ball, stashing your valuables inside, and then placing the ball back between two others in their original tube container. Just make sure that the goods don't rattle when you shake them. (You can stuff some tissue paper in with jewelry or coins to hide their sound.)

